00359382 SATB A Cappella

LEAD WITH LOVE

WORDS AND MUSIC BY MELANIE DEMORE

EUGENE ROGERS
FOUNDING DIRECTOR & SERIES EDITOR

EXIGENCE

A Sphinx Vocal Ensemble

Cover photos by Kevin Kennedy (kevinkennedy.com)

Mark Foster
MUSIC

NOTES FROM THE COMPOSER

Lead With Love was written in answer to a call for connection in troubled times. It is about persistence, community and moving ahead. "One foot in front of the other" is a metaphor for determination and forward motion . I think of love warriors like Martin Luther King, Nelson Mandela, Mother Teresa, Ghandhi, Dolores Huerta. All of them started their movements out of the love of their people not out of the hatred of someone else.

When singing this song in concert it is my request that you invite the audience to sing with you. This song is not meant to be 'listened to', it is for all to be a part. There's no need to 'teach' it to them. Always begin with a few measures of hand clapping on 2 and 4 so that folks can join in.

On the last chorus, I often sing 'we' gotta put, etc, instead of 'you'.

TEXT

You gotta put one foot in front of the other and lead with love,
Put one foot in front of the other and lead with love!

Don't give up hope, You're not alone,
Don't you give up, keep movin' on.

Chorus

Lift up your eyes and don't you despair.
Look up ahead, the path is there.

Chorus

I know you're scared, and I'm scared, too
But here I am, right next to you!

Chorus

DURATION: 2 minutes 30 seconds

BIO

Melanie DeMore : Vocal Activist - is one of the most outstanding vocal artists of today helping to preserve the African American Folk Tradition through song and Gullah stick pounding. She was the subject of a documentary called *Stick and Pound* which showcases this tradition. She has a career spanning 30 years dedicated to teaching, lecturing, mentoring, conducting, directing and inspiring children and adults about the power of song as social and political change. Melanie is a sought after presenter, conductor and soloist at national and international choral and music festivals, including Festival 500 in Newfoundland, Canada and Chorus America.

She is sought after as a song/ prayer facilitator, creating spontaneous choirs for *The Trinity Institute, The Haas Institute for a Fair and Inclusive Society* and the Powell Foundation as well as many varied spiritual and faith based organizations. She is adjunct faculty at the California Institute for Integral Studies, Master teaching Artist for CalPerformances at UC Berkeley, a featured presenter for *SpeakOut!* the Institute for Social and Cultural Change and was the Artistic Conductor of *The Oakland Children's Community Choir with Living Jazz* for nine years.

She was a founding member of the Grammy nominated, Linda Tillery and the Cultural Heritage Choir and has had the pleasure of sharing the stage with such varied artists as Odetta, Richey Havens, Pete Seeger, the Trinity Choir, MUSE Cincinatti Women's Chorus, The International Threshold Choirs and many others.

Melanie DeMore is a singer/songwriter, composer ,conductor and vocal activist, who believes in the power of voices raised together.

She says:

'A song can hold you up when there seems to be no ground beneath you".

LEAD WITH LOVE

SATB a cappella

Words and Music by
MELANIE DeMORE

Swing ♩ = ca. 152 (♫ = ♩♪)

Soprano
Alto

mf

You got-ta put one foot in front of the oth - er and lead with love,

Tenor
Bass

mf

4

Put one foot in front of the oth - er and lead with love! You got-ta put

9

one foot in front of the oth - er and lead with love, Put one foot in front of the oth-

14

** *Solo* ***f***

Don't give up hope, You're not a-lone,

f

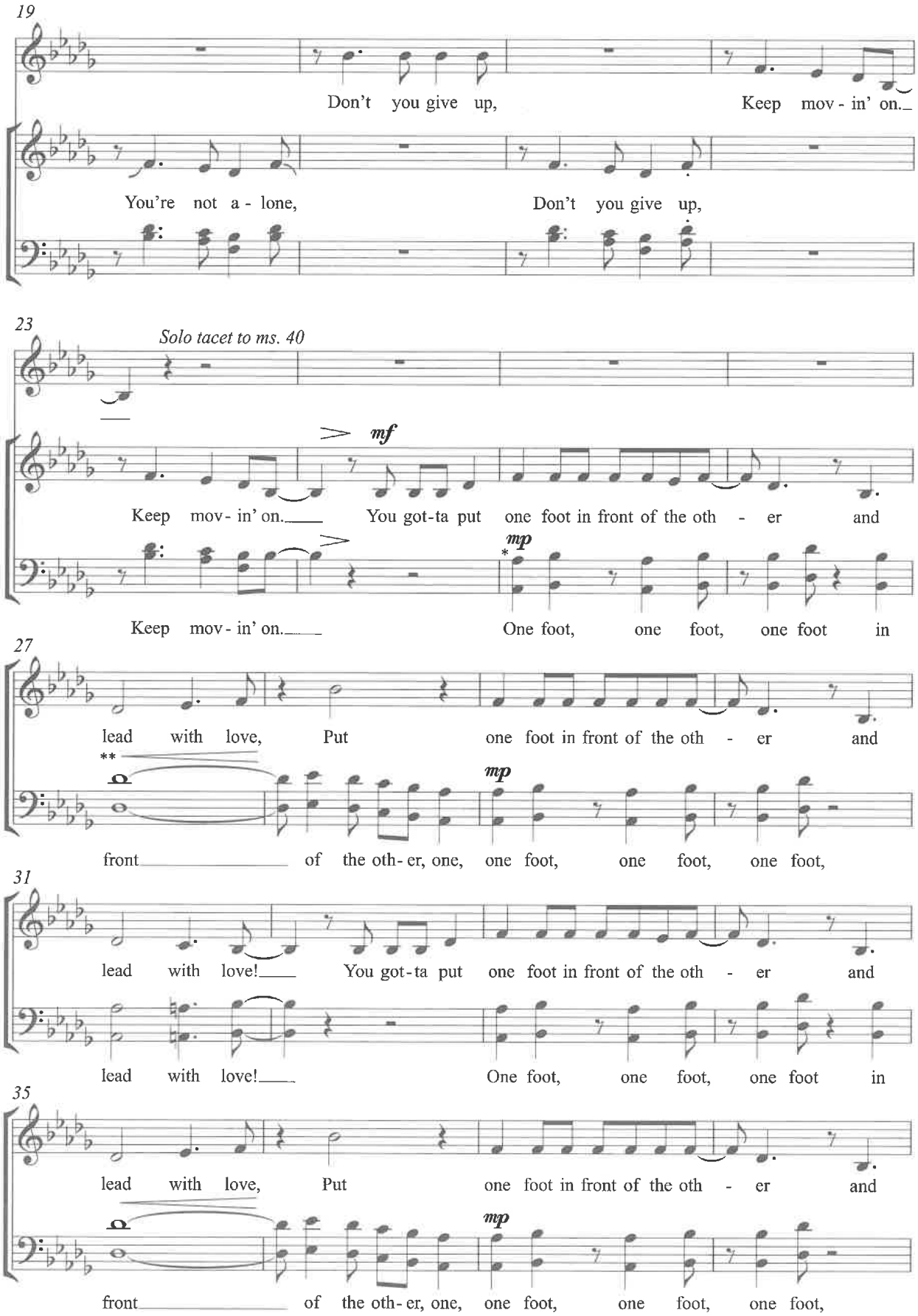
- er and lead with love! Don't give up hope,

f

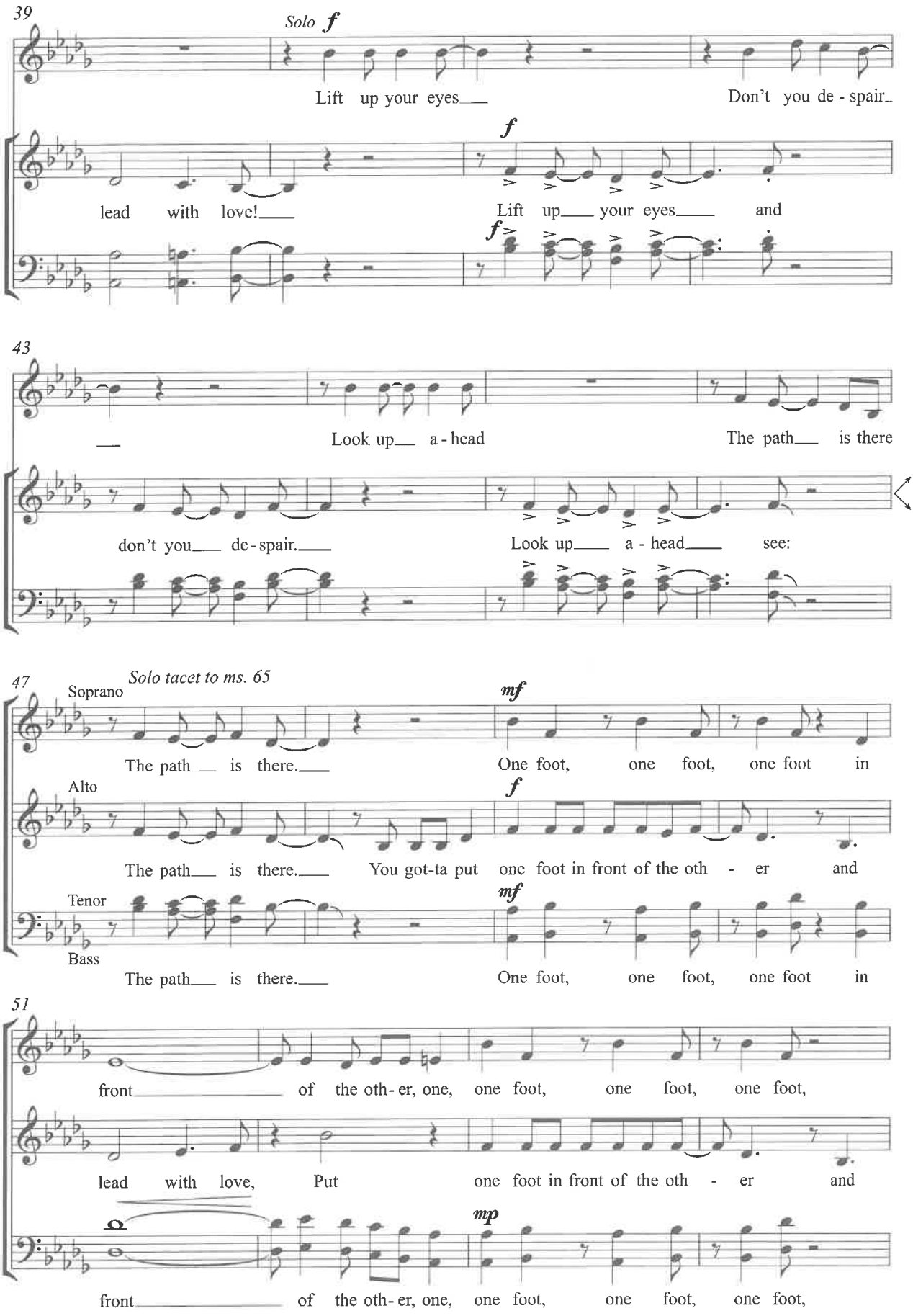
*** Visit sheetmusicdirect.com to purchase and download digital choral scores and audio (MP3s).**
**** Audience is invited to echo the soloist throughout the entire piece.**

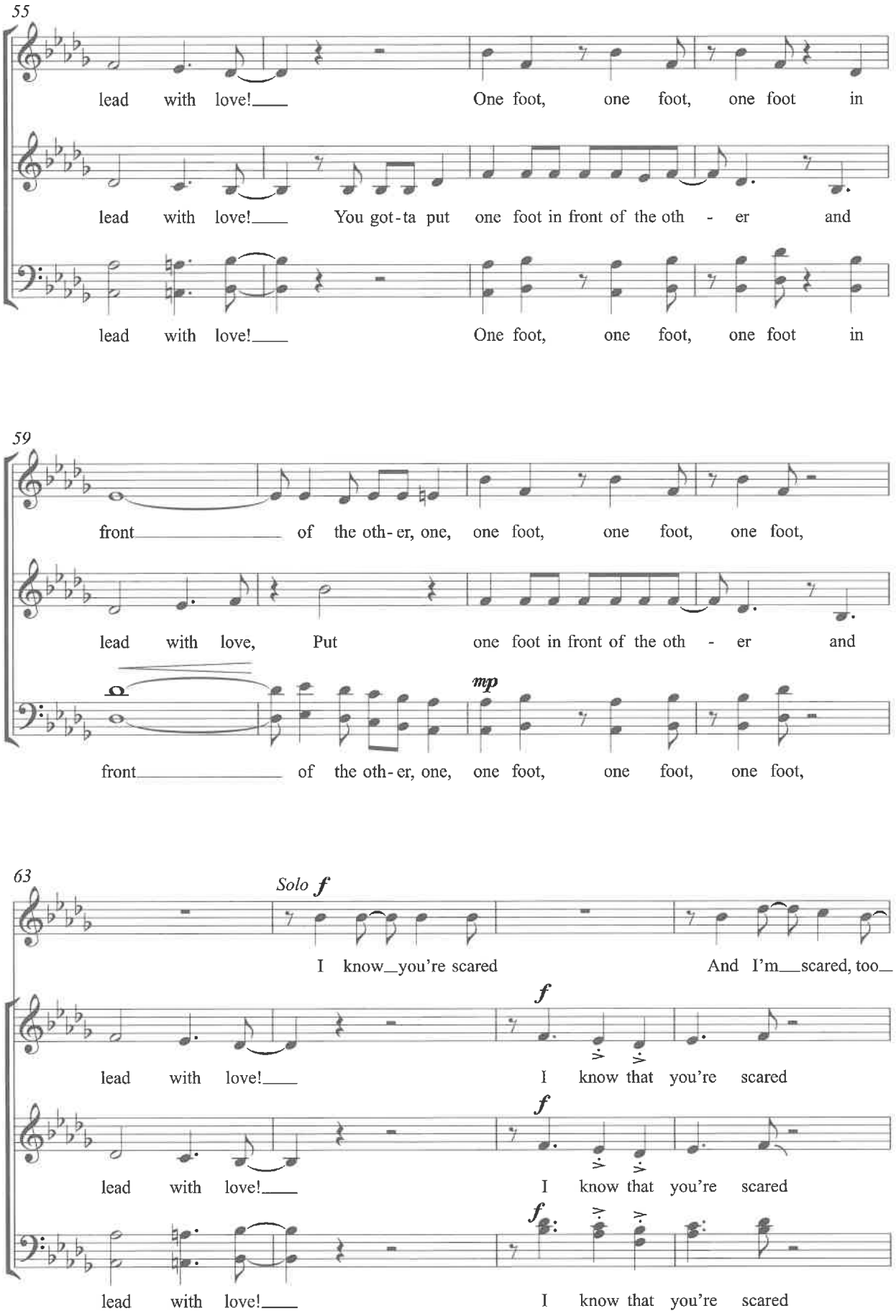
© 2017 Melanie DeMore
This arrangement © 2020 Melanie DeMore
All Rights Reserved Used by Permission

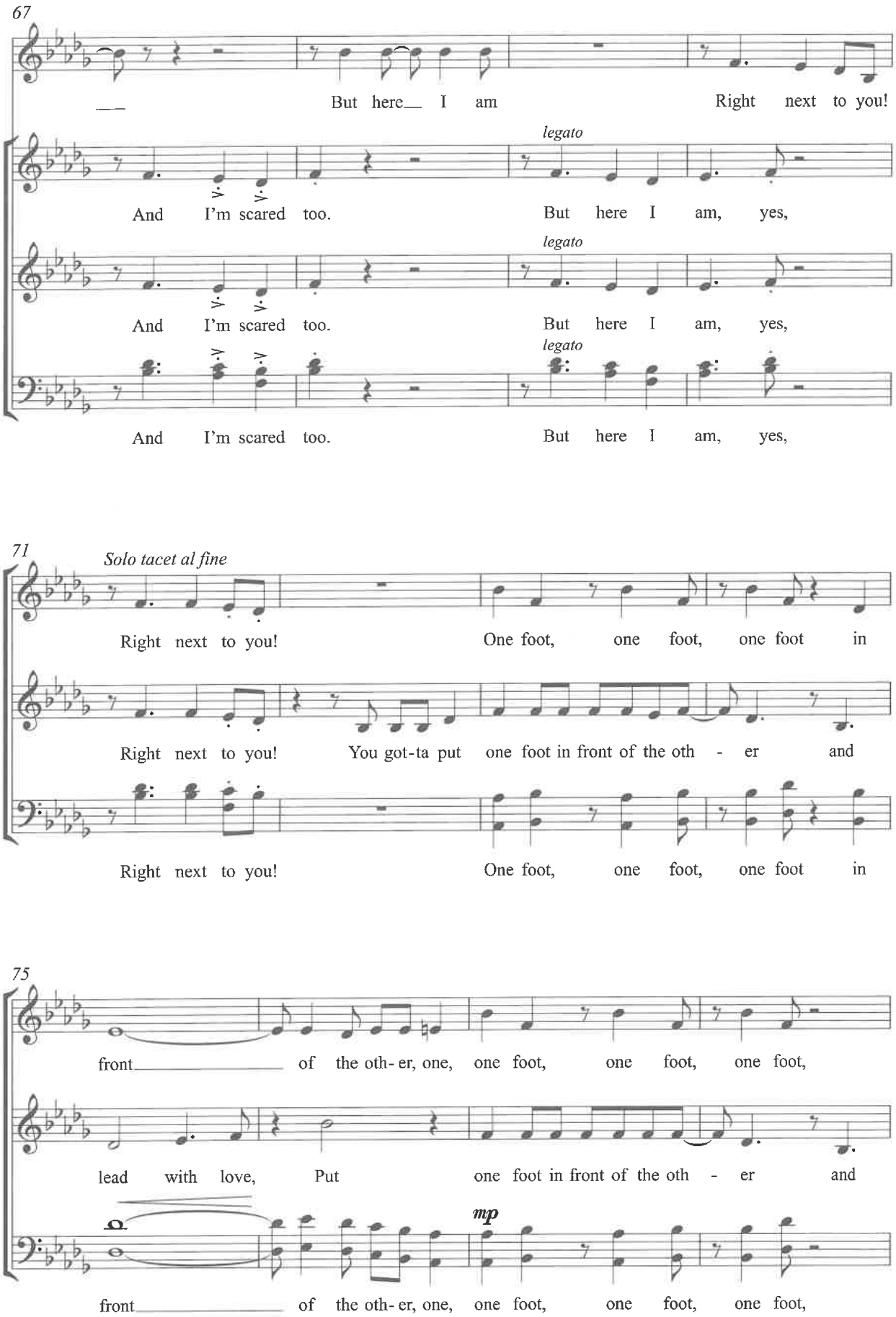
COPYING IS ILLEGAL



* Lower notes optional through ms. 40.
** Tenors & Basses swell to *f* on the tied whole note each time this happens.


39
Solo f
Lift up your eyes
Don't you de - spair
lead with love!
f
Lift up your eyes and
f
43
Look up a - head
The path is there
don't you de - spair.
Look up a - head see:
47
Soprano
Solo tacet to ms. 65
mf
The path is there.
One foot, one foot, one foot in
Alto
f
The path is there.
You got-ta put one foot in front of the oth - er and
Tenor
Bass
mf
The path is there.
One foot, one foot, one foot in
51
front of the oth- er, one, one foot, one foot, one foot,
lead with love, Put one foot in front of the oth - er and
mp
front of the oth- er, one, one foot, one foot, one foot,


55
lead with love! One foot, one foot, one foot in
lead with love! You got-ta put one foot in front of the oth - er and
lead with love! One foot, one foot, one foot in
59
front of the oth-er, one, one foot, one foot, one foot,
lead with love, Put one foot in front of the oth - er and
mp
front of the oth-er, one, one foot, one foot, one foot,
63
Solo f
I know you're scared And I'm scared, too
f
lead with love! I know that you're scared
f
lead with love! I know that you're scared
f
lead with love! I know that you're scared


67
But here I am Right next to you!
legato
And I'm scared too. But here I am, yes,
legato
And I'm scared too. But here I am, yes,
legato
And I'm scared too. But here I am, yes,
71
Solo tacet al fine
Right next to you! One foot, one foot, one foot in
Right next to you! You got-ta put one foot in front of the oth - er and
Right next to you! One foot, one foot, one foot in
75
front of the oth- er, one, one foot, one foot, one foot,
lead with love, Put one foot in front of the oth - er and
mp
front of the oth- er, one, one foot, one foot, one foot,

79

lead with love! One foot, one foot,

lead with love! You got - ta put one foot in front of the oth -

lead with love! One foot, one foot,

82

one foot in front of the oth- er, one, one foot, one foot,

- er and lead with love, Put one foot in front of the oth-

mp

one foot in front of the oth- er, one, One foot, one foot,

86

one foot, lead with love, lead with love,

- er and lead with love, and lead with love,

one foot, lead with love, lead with love,

90

Slower

rit.

lead with love, lead with love!

rit.

and lead with love, and lead with love!

rit.

lead with love, lead with love!

8 40126 94588 1

Scan for pricing & details